



V. SUBRAMANIAN, as SECY, NEW AND RENEWABLE ENERGY, **SPENT 34 DAYS ABROAD**, spending Rs 35,12,000.

ANJALI PRASAD, as JS, AGRICULTURE, **SPENT Rs 25,94,983 WHILE STAYING ABROAD FOR 71 DAYS.**

G. GURUCHARAN, JS, OVERSEAS AFFAIRS, **TRAVELLED FOR 63 DAYS and SPENT Rs 23,59,413.**

****SATWANT REDDY**, as SECY, CHEMICALS AND FERTILISERS. **HE SPENT 39 DAYS ABROAD, SPENDING Rs 30,90,017.**

*** In five of eight trips, she was accompanied by another official.*

Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises

OFFICIALS TRAVELLED: 36 Expenses: Rs 1,25,27,031
Km: 9,52,211 Stayed abroad: 400 days

NAME	DAYS SPENT ABROAD	NO OF TRIPS	EXPENSES (in Rs)
**CHANDRAPAL , SECY	50	9	31,76,736
PRAVIR KUMAR , JS	37	6	13,69,725

*** This includes a trip of six member delegation which cost Rs 8.07 lakh.*



RAHUL KHULLAR, AS, COMMERCE, **SPENT 199 DAYS ABROAD.**
Total expenses incurred: Rs 41,67,277.

118 officials of the Ministry of Water Resources travelled **18,86,876 km**, spending **1,530 days** at foreign destinations incurring a total expenditure of **Rs 1,51,18,953.**

able an increase in foreign trade and bilateral treaties but even then it's hard to justify the magnitude of such trips. It is not as if the babus of the commerce department are the only ones who are flying high. Besides commerce, six other ministries including Water Resources, Finance, Home Affairs, Information and Broadcasting, Agriculture, and Science and Technology have earned the distinction of frequent fliers—each of these ministries have logged 1,000 days or more of travel abroad.

In terms of expenditure, officials of 18 ministries have spent over Rs 1 crore each. The number of travellers in each ministry is sizeable with at least 13 ministries having a minimum of 50 officials who travelled abroad. These ministries with Defence in the lead (166) include Home Affairs, Finance, Water Resources, Commerce, Information and Broadcasting, Agriculture, Health and Family Welfare, Labour and Employment, Communications and IT, Urban Development and Science and Technology. However, the Ministry of Defence did not reveal the details of expenses incurred on the trips of their officials.

At the other end of the spectrum is the Ministry of Environment and Forests where despite the global buzz on climate change, only five officials have travelled, 2.88 lakh km, spending Rs 43.85 lakh and staying abroad for 111 days. Thirty five officials of the Ministry of Textiles have travelled more than 10 lakh km and stayed 559 days abroad spending over Rs 1.32 crore.

All the ministries have stressed that the trips are "purely official". The Ministry of Finance guidelines state, "No officer should undertake more than four official visits abroad a year". And if there is an exception, the proposal is considered by the screening committee of secretaries for officials of every rank. Restrictions have indeed been placed on the secretaries. For instance, the Cabinet Secretariat circular says, "Secretaries to the Government of India should travel only in the most essential circumstances and when unavoidable." But such guidelines are observed more in breach.